Gwynedd Mercy University-School of Business & Education
(*Must be used for each lesson observed by University Supervisor*)
Lesson Plan Framework

Subject Area: Executive Skills / Emotional Awareness & Coping Strategies Grade Level: 9–12

Student Name: Grace Dittman

PA Standard(s): PA Health, Safety and Physical Education 10.3.9.C / 10.3.12.C: recognize conflict situations and identify strategies to avoid or resolve them, including walking away and adult intervention. The lesson also supports emotional wellness, self-awareness, and appropriate coping responses. Pennsylvania's current Health, Safety and Physical Education standards remain the adopted standards while revisions are under review.
Students will consider and reflect on throughout the lesson: What am I feeling? What is causing the feeling? Is this a big or small problem? Can the trigger be removed? Do I need to take a step away?
Success Criteria Students will complete at least four of five trigger/coping-strategy examples on the worksheet with an appropriate strategy. Students may use words, short phrases, examples, or another approved communication method.
Differentiated Instruction Provide visual supports and the five-question decision sequence; read directions aloud; chunk the worksheet; provide sentence starters/word banks; allow students to choose from a visual list of coping strategies; provide extended processing time; model examples before independent work; allow verbal, written, typed, or other approved response formats; check in individually as needed. Students needing additional challenge may explain why a strategy fits a particular trigger or identify more than one possible strategy.

Domain II: Classroom Environment Students enter and begin the established daily check-in routine. The class follows predictable transitions: check-in, group game, video/discussion, direct instruction, worksheet practice, and independent work.	**Classroom/Behavior Management Plan & Routines** Maintain a calm, respectful environment. Students may participate verbally or through an approved alternative communication method. Students are reminded that personal examples may be kept private and that they may use a hypothetical school-appropriate example instead. Teacher provides positive reinforcement, proximity, redirection, and private check-ins when needed. During

	independent work, students may transition to missing assignments after completing the coping-strategy worksheet.

Activate Prior Knowledge/Motivation

Connect the lesson to the previously taught emotional awareness lesson. Explain: “Today we're going to take that one step further and use our emotional awareness to figure out what to actually do when a strong feeling comes up.” Students will recall that recognizing and naming emotions is the first step toward responding appropriately.

Vocabulary

Trigger; coping strategy; emotion/feeling; emotional awareness; problem size; remove the trigger; step away; calm down; response.

Sequence

1. Daily check in (3-5 minutes)
2. Do group activity (wordle,contexto, set game, etc) on the board (5-8 minutes)
3. Introduce todays topic “identifying coping strategies” (1 minute)
4. Show video on triggers and coping strategies (5 minutes)
5. Discuss emotional awareness (last week’s lesson) and let students know we will be talking about the next steps (choosing a coping strategy after they have identified their emotions) (5 minutes)
6. Discussion: "Today we're going to take that one step further and use our emotional awareness to figure out what to actually do when a strong feeling comes up.
   This slide gives us a simple set of questions to walk through whenever something's bothering us. Let's go through them one at a time.
   First: What are you feeling?
   Before we can decide what to do, we have to name the feeling. Are you frustrated? Nervous? Angry? Disappointed? Just naming it already gives us a little bit of control over it.
   Second: What is causing this feeling?
   Every feeling has a trigger — something that happened right before it. Maybe a friend said something that upset you, or an assignment felt too hard, or your plans got changed last minute. Figuring out the 'why' helps us figure out what to do next.
   Third: Is this a big problem or a small problem?
   Not every problem needs the same response. A small problem — like someone cutting in line — might just need a deep breath. A big problem — like a real conflict with a friend — might need a bigger strategy, or even an adult's help. Sizing up the problem helps us pick the right tool for it.
   Fourth: Can the trigger be removed?
   Sometimes we actually can change the situation. If a loud noise is bothering you, you might be able to move somewhere quieter. If a certain conversation is stressing you out, you might be able to politely step out of it. Not every trigger can be removed — but it's always worth

asking.

Fifth: Do I need to take a step away?

Sometimes the best thing we can do is give ourselves some space — a short break, a walk, a few minutes alone — before we respond to anything. Stepping away isn't giving up, it's giving yourself time to calm down so you can think clearly.

So next time something's bothering you, try walking through these five questions in your head. They won't solve every problem, but they'll help you figure out what kind of coping strategy actually fits the moment." (10 minutes)

7. Introduce worksheet: identify a trigger and find a coping strategy that can go with it to help you stay calm: we will go over 2 examples together and the students will finish the last three on their own (10 minutes)
8. They can work on missing assignments when the worksheet is complete

Closure / Teacher Reflection Notes

Closure: Students will name or select one coping strategy they could use in a future situation. Teacher summarizes the connection between emotional awareness, identifying a trigger, sizing the problem, and selecting a coping strategy.

Monitoring for Understanding: Teacher listens for accurate identification of feelings/triggers during discussion and checks whether worksheet strategies are reasonable and safe for the situation described.

Possible Next Step: Use student worksheet responses to identify common coping strategies that may need additional practice. Future lessons can focus on practicing selected strategies in realistic school situations.

Overall Assessment: The lesson will be evaluated based on student participation, discussion responses, successful completion of the worksheet, and the appropriateness of selected coping strategies. The teacher will adjust the amount of modeling or guided practice based on student independence.

Standards note: PA Health, Safety and Physical Education standards were referenced for conflict-resolution and safe-response skills.